

Lesson 19

Topic: Publishing and Sharing in Power BI

Prerequisites: Give a written brief explanation for all questions.

1. What is the difference between Power BI Desktop and Power BI Online Service?

Power BI Desktop is a free Windows application used for creating reports, building data models, and performing data transformations. It is mainly used by report developers on their local machines.

Power BI Online Service (also called Power BI Service) is a cloud-based platform accessed via a web browser. It is used to publish, share, collaborate, and schedule refreshes for reports and dashboards.

In simple terms:

Desktop = For designing reports.

Online Service = For publishing and sharing with others.

Key Differences:

Power BI Desktop works offline, while Power BI Online Service is web-based.

Desktop is used by developers; Online Service is used by end-users and teams.

Sharing and collaboration are only possible through Power BI Online Service.

Reports are first created in Desktop and then published to the Online Service for broader use.

2. How do you publish a Power BI report from Desktop to the Online Service?

Steps to Publish a Report:

1. **Open your report** in Power BI Desktop (.pbix file).
2. Click on the **“Publish”** button in the **Home** tab on the top ribbon.
3. Sign in with your **Power BI (work/school) account**, if not already signed in.
4. Choose the **destination workspace** in the Power BI Service (e.g., My Workspace or any shared workspace).
5. Click **“Select”** to publish.

6. You will see a confirmation message:
“Success! Your report was published to Power BI.”
7. Click on “**Open in Power BI**” to view it in the browser.

3. What is a workspace in Power BI? What are the types of workspaces available?

What is a Workspace?

A **workspace** in Power BI is a **collaborative environment** in the **Power BI Online Service** where users can:

- Publish, organize, and manage reports, dashboards, and datasets.
- Control **access** and **permissions** for team members.
- Collaborate on content before sharing it with a wider audience (e.g., through apps).

It acts like a **folder or container** for all Power BI content.

Types of Workspaces in Power BI:

Type	Description
My Workspace	- Personal workspace for individual users. - Only the user can access it unless they share specific content. - Ideal for testing or personal work.
Shared/Collaboration Workspace (App Workspace)	- Created by users for team or organizational collaboration. - Multiple members can be added with different roles (Admin, Member, Contributor, Viewer). - Content in these workspaces can be published as Power BI Apps for wider distribution.

4. What is the difference between a workspace and an app in Power BI?

- A **workspace** is a place to build, edit, and collaborate on Power BI content.
- An **app** is a **read-only packaged version** of workspace content shared with end-users.
- Use workspaces for development, apps for deployment.

5. Explain the different Power BI license types and their limitations.

License	Description	Limitations
Free	Limited to personal use in Power BI Desktop and My Workspace.	Cannot share reports or access shared content.
Pro	Full sharing, collaboration, and publishing to workspaces.	Needed for sharing content and using apps.
Premium Per User (PPU)	Pro features + advanced capabilities like paginated reports, AI, larger data models.	Requires PPU license for both creator and viewer.
Premium Capacity	Organization-wide capacity, no per-user Pro needed for viewing shared content.	High cost, ideal for large organizations.

6. How can you share a report with someone who doesn't have a Pro license?

Use Premium Capacity: Place content in a Premium workspace; users with Free licenses can then view it.

Otherwise, sharing to non-Pro users is not allowed.

7. What is a semantic model (dataset) in Power BI, and where is it stored in the service?

A semantic model (previously called a dataset) is the structured data model containing tables, measures, and relationships.

It is stored in the Power BI Service when you publish a report and is reused across multiple reports or dashboards.

8. How does Scheduled Refresh work in Power BI Online Service?

Scheduled Refresh lets you automatically update datasets in the Power BI Service.

Set in the dataset settings: choose refresh frequency and time

Requires a gateway if the data source is on-premises.

9. What is the difference between a dataset and a dataflow in Power BI?

Feature	Dataset	Dataflow
Purpose	Used in reports; stores data models and measures.	Used to prepare/transform data using Power Query Online.
Created In	Power BI Desktop or Service	Power BI Service

Reusability Not easily reused across workspaces Easily reused across multiple datasets and reports

10. When and why would you use a dataflow instead of a dataset?

Use a **dataflow** when:

- You want **centralized ETL logic** reusable by multiple datasets.
- You're working with **large volumes** of data.
- You want to **offload transformation** logic to the cloud.

11. What are dashboards in Power BI Online? How are they different from reports?

- A **dashboard** is a **single-page canvas** with visuals (tiles) pinned from one or multiple reports.
- **Difference from Reports:**
 - Dashboards are interactive but not detailed like reports.
 - Dashboards are only available in **Power BI Service**, not Desktop.

12. How do you pin a visual to a dashboard from a report?

- Open a report in Power BI Service.
- Click the **pin icon** on a visual.
- Choose an existing or new **dashboard** to pin it to.

13. What is the mobile view in Power BI and why is it useful?

- Mobile View is a layout mode that lets you **optimize reports for mobile devices**.
- It ensures better usability on smartphones and tablets.

14. What is a paginated report in Power BI and when would you use it?

- Paginated Reports are **pixel-perfect, printable reports** ideal for invoices, statements, or legal forms.
- Best used when you need to print or export **multi-page** tabular data.

15.Can you export reports from Power BI Service to PDF or PowerPoint? How?

- Yes.
- In Power BI Service:
 - Click on **File > Export > PDF or PowerPoint**.
 - Only the visible pages and visuals are exported.

16.What does “Live Connection” mean in Power BI Service, and how does it work?

- A Live Connection means the report connects directly to a **Power BI semantic model** or **SSAS model** without importing data.
- Data stays in the source, and queries run in real-time.

17.Explain Row-Level Security (RLS) and how it’s applied in Power BI Online.

- RLS restricts data access for users based on defined rules (e.g., region = "East").
- Defined in Power BI Desktop, then roles are assigned in the Service.

18.How can you test RLS roles in Power BI Service?

- Go to the dataset in Power BI Service.
- Click **Security**, choose a role, then click "**Test as Role**" to simulate what users see.

19.What are Apps in Power BI and how do you publish one?

- **Apps** are collections of dashboards and reports shared from a workspace.
- To publish:
 - Go to the workspace > click “**Publish app**” > configure settings and audience > click “**Publish**”.

20. What are some key benefits of using the Power BI Online Service in enterprise environments?

- Cloud-based collaboration and sharing.
- Centralized access control and security.
- Scheduled refresh and governance features.
- Access from any device, anytime.
- Scalable with Premium capacities.